CONSUL GUIDE TO CAREERS

Build an altruistic career that makes you feel appreciated, helpful, and successful

16Personalities

Table of Contents

Introduction 3
Academic Path 4
How Consuls Learn 4
Consuls in High School 10
Work or College? 14
Consuls in College 19
Lifelong Learning 24
Conclusion. 28
Professional Development 29
Jobs and General Skill Sets. 31
Workplace Roles 32
Consuls as Employees 33
Consuls as Colleagues 36
Consuls as Managers 39
Workplace Cooperation Between Types . . . 42
Consul-Analyst Cooperation 43
Consul-Diplomat Cooperation 47
Consul-Sentinel Cooperation 51
Consul-Explorer Cooperation 55
Conclusion. 59
Final Words 60
So... What's Next? 61

Introduction

Why Academic and Professional Development Matter to Consuls

Guided by their sense of duty and commitment, Consuls often excel in academia and work. Whether crafting a thesis project or pitching a sales strategy, people with this personality type aim to exceed expectations. But they aren't go-getters just for the sake of achievement – their work is intricately tied to their altruistic values. As in other areas of their lives, they feel moved to help others – whether their colleagues, their classmates, or the public. And they enjoy doing so through collaborative, team-oriented work.

In both the classroom and the boardroom, Consuls prefer to follow an established, clear-cut path to success. When given a tried-and-tested process to follow, there's little that people with this personality type can't do. And because they hold such deep respect for traditional rules and guidelines, they're known for being reliable, productive students and employees. They can be trusted to stick to protocol, even when it would be easier to do otherwise.

This dedication makes Consuls irreplaceable in their academic groups and workplaces. They rarely – if ever – drop the ball when it comes to their commitments, and their social awareness can help reunite teams or groups that are on the verge of falling apart. However, their diligence isn't without some challenges. Their traditional ethos may not always mesh well with others, and if Consuls aren't careful, they may overwork themselves in an attempt to meet the high expectations that they place on themselves.

In these pages, we'll discuss how Consuls can overcome these and other common stumbling blocks to maximize their strengths in school and work – while still being the hardworking students and professionals that they strive to be.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Academic Path

Consuls learn best in an environment that applies the following three principles: structure, community, and pragmatism. Consuls thrive when these three principles are combined in the classroom but are likely to struggle if even one is absent. By identifying the strengths and weaknesses in their processes, Consuls can not only become more effective learners but better teachers as well.

How Consuls Learn

Their Ideal Instructor

Consuls prefer their instructors be the clearly defined head of the classroom. Student Consuls trust that a teacher is before them because of proper certification, training, and experience. In turn, they dislike muddling of the hierarchy. Consider, for example, teachers who try to be “friends” with students. Though Consuls are naturally friendly and enjoy spending time with their instructors, they would prefer if their teacher remained professional.

Consuls’ ideal instructor sets goals and clear objectives. Even if the tasks assigned are routine and repetitive, Consuls won’t mind if there is a clear reason for it. Their ideal learning environment includes timelines, adherence to the syllabus, classes that allow them to interact with their peers, and goals that can be achieved through dedicated studying.

Developed Focus

Studying is something that Consuls do very well. This type utilizes traditional learning methods like rote memorization, flashcards, paying

close attention to the required text, and *always* making time to do the work. These aren't innate talents, however. Consuls, even those who have short attention spans, practice sitting down and focusing on the task at hand. This includes studying strategies like sectioning out time – 25 minutes of straight studying with 5-minute breaks – or experimenting with their hours to find when they're most productive.

They want to focus so that they can do well according to their community's standards. Consuls strive to deliver good results, because they feel satisfied when they can make their family, friends, and various mentors proud. In turn, they don't readily understand those who don't share the same drive to study and do well in school, and this lack of understanding can lead to irritation within the normally warm type.

For the Community

Consuls enjoy being academically successful because it places them in good societal standing. They are proud that they're seen as competent and dependable. In fact, their greatest aspirations include making their family proud and being a successful member of the community. That is why they strive for careers that their community hold in high esteem – town doctor, nurse, or a teacher for example. Traditionally, these positions are more readily available to students who do well in school, and it is for this very reason that Consuls strive to meet the academic requirements.

Community is a cornerstone for Consuls, which is why they seek to involve themselves deeply within their own. This can be something small-scale, like a close friend group, or large-scale, like actively sitting in on their academic institution's board meetings.

In small-scale groups, Consuls are likely to check the emotional temperature of their peers. They may ask questions like "*Are you okay?*" or "*Do you need help?*". In these situations, they may chat with their classmates about any and everything – from their most recent breakup, the daily gossip, or their frustration with an instructor's methods.

If they're not working on their personal connections within the community, then Consuls are physically assisting those around them by helping to wash dirty science beakers, sharing their friend's "*Vote for Me*" poster, or taking notes for an absent group member.

Learning for Career Applicability

Consuls are pragmatic when it comes to academics. They are drawn to subjects where they're able to learn skills for a future career, which is why they prefer topics that heavily incorporate practical application. This might include applied mathematics, communications, and home economics. For example, a Consul who aspires to the medical field may focus on organic chemistry while in high school with the intent to build a strong foundation for further education.

They may be dismissive of abstract and philosophical courses because of the lack of real-world application – consider poetry, for example. Consuls certainly enjoy reading some choice works, but dedicating themselves to free-form creative expression can feel exasperating. If a debate or lecture goes on too long without landing on something useful, they may view the whole experience as wasteful, but they'll tolerate it to honor academic requirements. They're happy to have fun in school, but Consuls prize focus, too – academic tangents, even enjoyable ones, often make them feel like they're drifting.

Balanced Learning Habits

Personal Fulfillment

Consuls learn so that they can be contributing members of society. These warm people take pride in supporting the established order and do what is necessary to keep things moving in the right direction. Consuls build upon the foundation their society deems successful, try to fit into the culture, and mend things where they can. Every community has gaps, and Consuls learn what is necessary to fill those voids.

Balanced Consuls take these goals to heart, but also understand that while it's important to meet societal standards and expectations, it is equally important to fulfill their personal needs. Balancing community duties and personal satisfaction can manifest in an adult who is, say, a top-level teacher who dedicates their life to their students, but who also take the time for an hour-long, once-a-week cooking class to learn how to braise a turkey properly.

Responsible Work Ethic

Consuls are very hard workers who have trained themselves to maintain focus. They dislike the idea of not fulfilling their commitments and obligations – even if they didn't ask for them – and don't dismiss deadlines lightly. They complete all tasks to the best of their ability, as they would feel anxious doing otherwise.

That said, balanced Consuls aren't keen on sacrificing their health to meet a goal. They do what they can, but avoid things like all-nighters or skipping meals. Instead, they schedule in time to commit the effort needed to succeed, but also to sleep. They also recognize when "good enough" is good enough, setting aside unrealistic perfectionism in favor of what gets the job done.

Contrary to their strong sense of personal responsibility, balanced Consuls also let themselves cut loose with a night on the town with a group of friends. They balance a social life against their academics – if they're putting in the effort to do well, they recognize that they've earned a break. It's as the saying goes – "everything in moderation, including moderation."

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Loss of Independence

Consuls take pride in how they appear to their friends, colleagues, and community, and, most of all, their family. While they have difficulty admitting it, they are very concerned with their community's expectations.

People have two primary motivations – internal and external. Internal motivation is based on what a person wants from life, while external motivation is based on what society tells them what they should want. When Consuls' learning habits are unbalanced, they follow the latter in excess. Take, for example, Consuls choosing a specific university because their family has a long-standing tradition of attending, and not because they feel it is the best choice for them.

Following what others want is an issue, because, at the end of the day, Consuls' academic needs remain unfulfilled. They'll spend their time

meeting other's expectations that they don't take the time to discover who they are as individuals. *What are they talented at? What do they have a passion for? Where are areas they can improve upon?* – these are all very important questions that Consuls won't be able to answer if their sole focus is on fulfilling someone else's academic goals.

Expectation Overload

Consuls' expectations – being straight-A students, getting a respectable job, and never getting in trouble – come from a lifetime of meeting other's expectations (particularly their family's).

When their approach is unbalanced, Consuls will give an arm and a leg to meet expectations. They'll cause themselves undue stress worrying about deadlines and assignments or push themselves to the limit to balance all their obligations. This can look like Consuls giving up their entire weekend to focus on the studies they couldn't complete during the week due to extracurriculars. They want to meet the expectations that their community has placed on their shoulders, even if these expectations are implausible, if not downright impossible.

Both obligations and expectations give something, and they take something. They give a sense of certainty, and there's no doubt about how people should conduct their lives in their presence. But this certainty can come at a high price: A life lived more narrowly than needed, and experiences missed. If Consuls aren't exacting of themselves, they can make these expectations work. However, rigid and excessive expectations can lead to constant disappointment.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Learning for Personal Fulfillment

When Consuls prioritize what society tells them they want over what they actually want, they can begin to feel unfulfilled and, at times, resentful. Instead, Consuls can focus more on meeting their internal needs before meeting external needs and ultimately live healthier lives.

They can start by doing things that are fun, "unnecessary," but still useful to their academic careers. This should be relatively easy for

Consuls, as this type isn't afraid of bold moves – as long as they're also sensible moves. They'll move cross-country for a lucrative career, they'll buy a house that's on sale for a low price in an otherwise expensive neighborhood, they'll get married if they meet the person of their dreams, but none of this is done on a whim.

When adapting boldness to academics, one way they can go about things is to learn about a subject they thought was interesting in elementary school that also ties into their general course requirements. For example, having an interest in the stars when young, then taking Astronomy to fulfill a science requirement (even if their major is administration).

By making changes little by little, Consuls may at some point gather the courage to take a particularly big leap – like going off to a University that they enjoy (but isn't particularly prestigious), and refusing to let the expectations of society be the deciding factor. There will always be plenty of obligations in life, but narrowing them to only to those that are useful and relevant – and giving themselves leeway along the edges – can bring all manner of freedom.

Putting Themselves First

Unhealthy Consuls will go out of their way to meet the expectations of those around them, and ignore their own desires in the process (and in more extreme cases, be completely unaware of those desires). A valuable skill that Consuls develop is putting themselves first.

Putting themselves before others may seem selfish for these dutiful types, but learning to do so will lead to a more fulfilling life. Consuls can start by first acknowledging their desires. Not the desires of their parents, or their family, or their friends, but what genuinely makes *them* happy. For example, they can begin a feelings journal, and write in it three times in a week.

In this journal, they will try to capture their current moods, and trace their moods to events occurring at that time. They will then try to seek out the triggers for these moods, and then write down the lessons they've learned about themselves. The purpose of this journal is to increase self-knowledge. An example of an entry can be:

July 13, Satisfied, content, and inspired. Went to a craft show and was surprised by how much I liked it. Currently thinking about learning how to crochet. Imagining all the gifts I could make for my family. Feeling hopeful and excited.

Potential Lesson: I enjoy crafting, and it's something I'd like to keep learning about when I have time available.

Consuls in High School

Even as teenagers, Consuls are, typically, the ideal student. They're dedicated and polite, work to satisfy their instructor's expectations and enjoy working with their peers. While other students groan at the thought of going to school, Consuls flourish in the structured world of high school. As teens, they're not necessarily over-concerned with the future, but are simply following the established path. In high school, Consuls may benefit from their adherence to this path, however, this benefit could also be their greatest challenge.

Consuls tend to be social butterflies in high school. They do their best to get along well with others, and seldom have confrontations with their classmates. Like most people their age, Consuls have small groups of intimate friends, but they're also often proud of their popularity. Balanced Consuls happily intermingle with and include a broad range of groups and individuals. They tend to be popular people, and it isn't unusual to see Consuls voted Prom Queen or King, or "Student of the Year." However, less balanced Consuls can be mean-spirited to those who don't conform, which is responsible for the catty Consul stereotype.

Balanced High School Learning Habits

Peeking Outside the Box

Consuls excel within systems where structure and rules are enforced. This is why high school, with all its regimented glory, can be a great place for this type to demonstrate their success. However, Balanced Consuls understand that life outside their home and their walls may not be so narrow, which is why they take the time to explore options they find interesting. They look outside their own world to learn about

alternate options they hadn't realized existed. For this, they draw on their wide social connections to help them realize unconventional, but fascinating, paths. For example, that a teenage girl can pursue robotics software, too, and that there's nothing wrong with a teenage boy exploring poetry.

Balanced Consuls accomplish all necessary courses and meet reasonable expectations, but they also make sure to make time or invest more in the subjects they genuinely enjoy. Consuls who enjoy their Chemistry class can join the after-school Chemistry Club. They make sure to take the time to discover their passions and interests, develop their identity as well as any teenager can, rather than relying on the identity their community puts upon them.

Healthy Boundaries

As with other Sentinels, one of Consuls' greatest strengths in high school is their capacity to care for their fellow students. This isn't sweeping compassion as much as it is making sure the practical needs of their peers are met. If another student reaches out for help, Consuls try to support them to the best of their ability. Balanced Consuls who excel in a subject might help tutor a struggling student, especially if it means they can both get their homework done.

However, balanced Consuls make sure to distinguish between friendliness and being taken advantage of. They know that their tendency to be kind can be mistaken for weakness, but even then, they make it a point to be patient, yet assertive with any classmates with dubious intentions. A balanced Consul would stop a peer from cheating off their homework, because they believe that there's more merit in learning on one's own then copying answers and learning nothing in the process.

Unbalanced High School Learning Habits

Doing Only What's Expected

Consuls are dutiful and committed, driven to meet the expectations placed upon their shoulders. While this often works in their favor, it can also turn against them. This becomes evident when they, so focused on meeting requirements, miss out on doing the things they want and enjoy.

Finding joy in learning is important to the academic process, and Consuls may find that they have lost that joy somewhere along the way as they struggle to meet everyone's wants but their own. They may study to do well on a standardized test but find that they have learned nothing outside the bounds of that test.

Consuls also run the risk of not learning what they like or enjoy. They may never let themselves find their passion or talents while they're still in high school, which could lead to steeper challenges later on in work or higher education.

Too Diligent

Consuls are likely to work from the first day of high school to the day they graduate. They work hard and diligently meet all the requirements put in front of them. Other students may slack off when the work becomes too predictable and easy or when they get toward the end of high school. Consuls do not. They continue to work to their highest level until they leave.

While that may sound like a dream come true to many educators, there is a dark side. Consuls face enormous pressure to do what is expected and may be inclined to sacrifice their joys and needs to meet certain standards. If success is determined to be a perfect grade average, then Consuls may sacrifice their health (sleep, for example) to study.

Even if they don't feel well, Consuls may be reluctant to take time off, as they see it as their duty to attend to their education no matter what. This rarely bodes well, and Consuls may find that their pursuit of diligence has left them worn out. This exhaustion can lead to slipping grades, lessened ambitions, or unhappiness.

Rebalancing High School Learning Habits

Patience and Understanding

Consuls whose approach to school has become unbalanced have the tendency to be judgmental of those who don't follow tradition and community norms. Classic examples of this in high school are the "mean girl" or the "bully jock," but it can also be the rejection of the

"class clown" in a serious, buttoned-up academy, or criticizing a female student who embraces traditional femininity in an alternative women's studies course.

Because teenage Consuls fit in very well with their environment, they may hold frustration for people who don't uphold the same social and academic standards. They might think "Why can't you just do the work?" or "Is it so hard for you to sit quietly in class and listen?" They may criticize these people without taking the time to consider the other person's life, and what else could be going on beyond the demands of the classroom.

Consuls will let this perceived offender know how things should be done. They don't do it to be mean, but because they think this person will genuinely benefit from changing their ways. The problem with this is that people, more often than not, don't want to change and are likely to see Consuls' attempt to do so as irritating. Also, Consuls shouldn't seek to change people either, but instead develop patience and understanding.

They can begin developing these traits by cultivating curiosity about people they deem as "other." Consuls may see a person and determine that what they're doing is wrong. While this instant judgment may seem easier than getting to know the person, it would better serve Consuls to cultivate a curiosity about this person and their ways in order to avoid future confrontation.

Once a week, young Consuls can have a conversation with another student outside their immediate peer group. This conversation should require more than a brief chat about the weather, and more of a casual investigation as to why the other person prefers to do things the way they do. Consuls may be surprised to find that the other's choices are ideal for that person's life, and that adopting Consuls' own point of view would only make things more difficult.

Developing School-Life Balance

High school is difficult. With the added in pressures of the future, parents, and extracurriculars, it can be exhausting to even the laziest of people, and downright back-breaking to hardworking Consuls. Consuls

are always looking to do their best in whatever they commit to, and if something has to give, they sacrifice themselves to sustain their other obligations.

Sacrificing themselves is not the way to go. Here, young Consuls can develop healthy school life balance by creating a schedule. Creating this schedule will not only boost their productivity, but allow them time to hang out with friends, time to be alone and relax, and enjoy their lives as teenagers rather than breaking their backs to meet unrealistic expectations.

They can do this by creating a fixed schedule. Work when they need to work, and rest when they need to rest. This becomes possible by dedicating time to study, and then *stopping* when that time is over.

An example of this would be one hour of dedicated studying time during school hours (study hall, perhaps), and two hours after school. In those two hours, Consuls should focus on the most important tasks first – an essay due next week, five math equations, 30-minutes of assigned reading – and then close everything once those two hours are up.

During those two hours, distractions should be eliminated. A good place to start would be turning off their phone, logging out of social media, and removing themselves from social situations that would keep them from doing their work.

After this time, Consuls can dedicate their time extracurricular activities, or sitting down to finally finish the TV show they'd been putting off for two months.

Work or College?

Go to college? Or go into the workforce? This fork-in-the-road decision plagues all young adults as they prepare to leave the swaddling comfort of high school. And while personality type is not the only factor that goes into making this choice, it can be very important variable.

The question many Consuls have is whether it's more practical to enter a trade early to begin establishing a life or to bolster future security by obtaining a degree.

Core to Consuls' consideration is familial expectations, especially regarding what their family perceives as stable and successful. Consuls find themselves hard pressed to defy a family full of college graduates, or, on the other hand, a family full of people who immediately entered the workforce. Also, if the choice is available, are more likely to pick a local, but low-rated university to be closer to the community where they grew up.

However, it is important for Consuls to know that they have choices available to them. So, what are some things they may consider when making that choice?

Balanced Decision Making

Understanding the Path: Work

Most Consuls have an idea of the path they'd like to pursue after graduation from high school. This idea has been defined by familial expectations, but also expectations they have of themselves. They could make the choice to go into the workforce rather than continue on to higher education, and many Consuls do choose this path. If this decision is made healthily, then it is based on Consuls' self-knowledge and hearty pragmatism. The career they choose is likely a practical one, and it will also be one they find satisfaction in.

If they go straight into the workforce, it is because they have a well-defined career path in mind and have the resources available to make it happen. University at this point could be unnecessary. Consuls are anything but wasteful, and the idea of potentially spending huge amounts of money and time on something that could be irrelevant is painful for them to consider. If there isn't a sense of purpose or meaning in college, it's likely just to be a bad experience.

The difference between Consuls who choose university and Consuls who choose to immediately go into the workforce is that the former seeks formal training because they need added structure, while the latter can apply structure well enough to themselves, seeing through independent learning through practice or on-the-job training.

Understanding the Path: College

If they go for higher education, it is because they want to pursue a career that requires a degree or certification, or because they have a genuine fascination with a subject. They choose which university to attend based on their personal preferences and may pick a less prestigious university if a specific program – say nursing – is stronger than it would be at a top ranked school.

If Consuls need a degree or a certification for their desired career – teacher, social worker, nurse, or physician – then they'll get one. However, this type keeps practicality in mind as they search for an institution to provide that certification. To get what they need, this type rarely has a problem with going with the relatively economical choice of trade school or community college for their degree over the pricier 4-year university.

Balanced Consuls also seriously consider family's opinions of institutions. But while the weigh-ins of family and mentors are extremely important to Consuls, a balanced decision is based on how Consuls themselves feel about their school of choice. This is a type who values leadership, and that starts with themselves, so directing their own education is great practice.

Unbalanced Decision-Making

Fear of the Unknown

When Consuls approach decision-making, they are ruled by their Judging trait. They value propriety and planning, order and a known path. The idea of leaving what they know for a virtually unknown future can be deeply unsettling to Consuls. When presented with unfamiliar change, their otherwise decisive natures are replaced by paralysis and fear.

Fear of the unknown can force Consuls into early work (say, the family business), as they see it as a system that works. They don't choose to stay necessarily because they want to or because they like their work, but because the option of going down the road not taken may seem too stressful. It's not uncommon to find parent-child duos of nurses, lawyers, or any other profession that lends a service to others.

Consuls may also choose to go to university because it's traditionally the path that their family has taken. Even if Consuls have a career they prefer (and that doesn't require a college degree, or that requires a different certification), they may not want to go against the grain. The same can be said for Consuls who don't want to *leave* university because the job market is too unfamiliar and unpredictable – school is something they've grown accustomed to for nearly their entire lives. They may opt to become "professional students," remaining in the relatively regimented academic arena.

Selecting for Others

The opinions of parents or other admired mentors can be very important to Consuls. Family may come first for this type, and they make sure to include their loved ones in most aspects of their life – past, present, and future. Consuls may always be conscientious of societal expectations, and when their approach is unbalanced, they may pick a route solely because it is deemed "proper" or "acceptable" by the authority figures in their life.

It's at this point that Consuls may begin down a path of passive living. They don't live a life of their personal choosing, but a life dictated by the word of powerful loved ones. Even if Consuls detest the path set forth by their loved ones, they may feel as though they have to strictly adhere to social values, and make their family proud.

Rebalancing Decision-Making

Facing the Unknown

It isn't change that Consuls avoid, necessarily. They have no issue choosing to go into the workforce or go into higher education if they know what it'll involve. It's only when they don't know what's on the other side of that tunnel that they become nervous and, ultimately, avoidant. Facing challenges, however, creates a better-rounded and therefore more stable person.

The key to facing the unknown is understanding that it's acceptable to fail. Consuls may have it in their mind that they can only be model students or model employees, and nothing less. And the only way to accomplish that is if they can see the path clearly before them.

While they may not always be able to see a defined path, Consuls can gain confidence when facing the unknown by visualizing future obstacles and struggles. Consuls might take some time to imagine that an exam doesn't focus on what they studied for. What could they do to recover from this as they sit in the classroom, staring at unfamiliar content? By developing a strategy in advance, they can recover quickly from a very challenging situation – it was expected.

- Fall back on standard exam-taking techniques, like eliminating possibilities or looking through previous and future questions to see if one question provides the answer for another;
- Commit in advance to asking the teacher for clarification, a tremendously valuable technique that rarely occurs to a flustered student;
- Follow up with the teacher after the exam to make sure that in the future, they know where their attention can best be focused as they review material – a failure here is an opportunity to improve techniques, and it's rare for an instructor to reject a student who shows dedication to their course;
- Consider a difficult challenge that they were able to overcome successfully in the past.

Understanding Their Choice

Consuls should meditate on the reasons why they're making a certain decision. This is a type who relies heavily on the expectations of their community, and extra caution should be taken to ensure their making a choice based on their personal satisfaction rather than the satisfaction of others. Consuls can ask themselves the following questions:

- What are three main reasons they're deciding on this path?
- Have they taken the time explore other options? This includes visiting school, talking to their advisor, job exploration for other careers, internships, and so on.
- Are they making a choice based on their personal interests?
- If not, determine what they're interests are, and if they can pursue it more effectively through work or school.

For Consuls who have made a decision based off the expectations of others, it would be good to remember that it's never too late to pursue their interests. They can take the time needed to gracefully bow out of whatever field they're in and prepare for their preferred path.

Consuls in College

Consuls may have mixed feelings when entering college. There is an opportunity to gain some real skills and develop professional credentials. However, university life tends to have far less structure than high school, with a much greater demand for self-direction. This can be disconcerting to a student with as many fixed habits and beliefs as Consuls.

However, Consuls are hardly ones to back down from an exciting challenge, especially one with such a rich history. Even with these fixed habits and beliefs, college can be a time for Consuls to consider and build upon their strengths in a real way. Consuls may find this a time where they can develop competence. Consuls need to be careful to ensure that within their chosen major, that they make a point of reflecting on whether it's suitable for them. A major heavy in labs and practicums – like medicine, for example – will suit Consuls well. Also, Consuls respect practical knowledge as much as any hands-on work. Learning how to insert a syringe has equal weight to understanding the medical systems.

Consuls' course choices tend to be similar to the subjects they connected with in high school. They do well in any detail-oriented work that needs careful administration and social engagement: health care, education, law, social work, public relations, human resources, and religious studies to name a few. For Consuls, the value of a subject is defined by its application and purpose. It's unlikely they will be attracted to less traditional courses. They will instead seek more bedrock courses – perhaps something their parents might have taken a generation earlier.

The question for Consuls is not whether they can do something. They have the work ethic to do well in any niche they choose. Instead, they'll wonder if they'll feel of use. Some feel that college and university are only about gathering the tools need to make a good living. Consuls may fit into this category. However, they always have one eye on

contributing to their communities and taking care of others. Making a good living would likely be more about taking care of people over the gratuitous accumulation of wealth.

Balanced College Life

Conscientious and Responsible

In high school, Consuls knew where they had to be, and exactly what they had to do. While the same can be said for higher education, there's more fluidity and autonomy involved. The sudden freedom can be overwhelming to many young adults, which is why it's common for many first-year students to become depressed and unproductive as they try to find their new purpose in life.

Consuls are better equipped than most when it comes to the first-year blues. They've worked hard to develop the ability to plan and manage their time, develop useful study and notetaking skills, and how to draw on social resources. Yes, they may be away from friends and family, and yes, they're a change-averse type who has the been thrown wildly out of their element. Despite all that, Consuls will search and find the clearest path possible.

Involved in the Community

Balanced Consuls' main reason for choosing higher education is simple – to receive the certification or degree required for their chosen career. They understand the path they have embarked upon, and have chosen higher education for its focused implementation of a life plan. However, just as Consuls are diligent students, they also excel at involving themselves in the community.

Consuls make their education social, broad, engaged, and invigorating, taking advantage of not just the practical resources, but joining rowing or other team sports or clubs for both enjoyment and as resume boosters. But it's not just the resume that concerns them – they genuinely value what these programs teach about teamwork, leadership, grit, and other character-building aspects. For example, if Consuls were to join a student organization like a fraternity or a sorority, it wouldn't be for

the partying (though that is a bonus), but for the opportunity to make lifelong bonds with their peers.

Unbalanced College Life

The Straw That Broke the Camel's Back

Consuls are naturally inclined to overload themselves. Whether it be the pressures of academia, the needs of others, or the expectations they have of themselves, Consuls can too easily take this too far. Sooner or later, they'll bow or break under the cumulative weight of it all. There's only so much they can take on before they simply don't have enough time in the day.

In high school, Consuls' ability to stress themselves out was lower due to smaller workloads and fewer expectations. In college, however, Consuls have free rein to express their undue perfectionism within their chosen courses and activities. They will also add stress to their lives by pushing for too much detail and will make lofty demands of themselves. These demands may look like not allowing themselves leniency when they make mistakes, pushing themselves too hard to achieve and maintain high grades, and forcing themselves to meet the expectations of family members and loved ones.

As the weight becomes heavier and heavier, Consuls may rant and rave about their stresses, assuming that it's just the way of life, that things are meant to be difficult. It may not even occur to them that their workload isn't normal, and that the real, underlying cause is that they signed up for too much.

Unyielding and Rigid

Consuls are the "stick-to-it" kind of people. Once they decide on a course, it can be very difficult to get them off it (even it is completely unsuitable for their needs). Consider Consuls who choose a major they don't particularly like. Rather than switching majors, they will see this particular major out for the next four years in the name of commitment.

This sort of rigidity can also be seen when Consuls are confronted with unfamiliar ideas that clash with their existing beliefs. A devoutly religious

individual may struggle with ideas presented in scientific courses, or they might react strongly against protest groups rather than listening to what they have to say, or even adopt or lead censorship initiatives. The same can be said for Consuls raised in more liberal settings, who refuse to even consider what a more conservative student is saying, and immediately label them as "wrong" and not worth listening to.

Rebalancing College Life

Reshaping Unreasonable Expectations

While Consuls in high school had issues with taking breaks, Consuls in university may be unwilling to deal with root of their stress – meeting unreasonable expectations. If the expectations of their loved ones include maintaining a perfect grade point average, while taking a full course load of rigorous classes, while keeping up with various clubs and organizations, while also going out with friends regularly, and having a part time job, then it's safe to say that that's a little unreasonable.

Consuls are warm people and apply pragmatic fairness when they can. If a friend were to come to them and vent about the same stresses listed above, they would give advice as to what they would do in the same situation. Funnily enough, they are reluctant to take their own advice.

The first step to dealing with the issue of heavy expectations is to acknowledge that these expectations unreasonable. A simple way to check if they're unreasonable is to ask the question: "Would I ask someone else to do all these things?".

This type may treat their suffering lightly, joking loudly about it with their classmates with barely restrained panic. They will grit their teeth and bear the pain, sometimes ignoring their emotions completely. However, to be a better-rounded person, it is necessary to understand that it's okay not to be okay.

Consuls can combat these self-blaming tendencies by practicing self-compassion exercises. These exercises can range to meditation to talking with close friends or family. One exercise in particular is the

self-compassion letter. In these exercises, Consuls will look closely at their feelings, and then think about if they're being fair to themselves.

Self-Compassion Letter

- Imagine the issue at hand – too many deadlines, overwhelming extracurricular work, not seeing friends enough
- Next, they will imagine someone who loves them unconditionally, and how that person would react to their current issues
- In the letter, they will ask themselves what are healthier ways to cope with the stressful occurrences
- Spend the next few minutes free writing about any and all negative emotions, while also imagining the person who loves them unconditionally

Reducing Rigidity

At the core of Consuls' personal rigidity is the fear of change. It's not that they are incapable of changing, but rather, they dislike having to halt all gears and reverse back to square one. This is why one will find Consuls in majors they dislike but are reluctant to leave. They may think "I've already come this far, might as well finish it."

The problem in this is when a bad choice in one's major can lead to only one kind of internship, that can lead to only certain types of careers, that can lead to a lifetime of settling in a path that Consuls didn't even want in the first place. Consuls can ask themselves a single question in situations like this: Do they value satisfaction and contentment more than complacency?

When it comes Consuls' rigidity in their social lives, one can turn to German philosopher Friedrich Nietzsche, who once said: "*You have your way. I have my way. As for the right way, the correct way, and the only way, it does not exist.*"

The right way does not exist. Consuls, when their approach is unbalanced, have a harder time than most remembering this. However, Consuls can be some of the warmest individuals, and they usually want the best for others. They can combine their natural warmth with open-mindedness to make closer, and more authentic relationships.

The first step in doing this is to consider the following whenever faced with an opposing view:

- Why does this view upset them?
- Does the person with the opposing opinion have direct impact on the Consul's life?
- Why is it better to *not* listen than to listen?
- Would there be more knowledge gained by listening than simply refusing to hear out the opposing opinion?

Lifelong Learning

For Consuls, "learning" is very much about gaining real-world-applicable skills. They gather what they need to create and maintain a stable life; as well as to better serve the people and organizations they care for. It is the purpose of community engagement that Consuls continue to learn. This is why they acknowledge formal education as a resource, and are aware of its ability to advance personal development.

As they mature, Consuls find what they consider necessary – family, community, and social circles – to expand. This could be things like learning how to garden so they can join in on their friends' gardening club, to how to have better relationships with their children, to generally increasing their resilience and grit. Other Consuls, however, may continue treading the same well-worn paths. They may stubbornly insist that, while they have not learned everything there is to know, they at least know what they *need* to know.

It should be noted that Consuls are aware that there's always something new to learn, something new to apply. For example, registered nurses are asked to update their knowledge of new procedures, guidelines, and medical happenings every year. If it is a case like this, then Consuls are more than willing to take tests and courses as long as it's needed.

Balanced Lifelong Learning

Making Time to Learn

Consuls find that as they get older, their obligations grow. It is very easy for this type to become completely swept up by the expectations of relationships, family, work, and the organizations they invest themselves in. However, well-rounded Consuls understand that a balanced life includes having time for oneself.

They make it a point to carve out time in their busy lives to indulge in learning skills they enjoy. While work and personal obligations are important, there is always room to incorporate new skills into their everyday routine. For example, Consuls who want to learn how to cook intricate recipes will take up a cooking class at their local community center.

Learning New Skills to Complement Old Lives

Consuls don't learn new things for the sake of novelty, but because they can apply it to the foundation of their lives. They take the time to look at the life they have presently and wonder how they can enrich it for both themselves and the ones they care about.

This can manifest in things like learning more about automobiles so they can handle minor car issues on their own, or picking up carpentry to create simple furniture pieces (that they can then pass on to their children), or even taking a dance class so they can participate in the annual town talent show.

On the topic of formal education, balanced Consuls may be open to pursuing more certifications and higher-level degrees if it would improve their career prospects. They understand that sometimes it's important to look in a new direction, and to make a plan to pursue that direction sensibly – developing a budget to pay for school, finding time in their schedules, and ensuring that the degree serves a purpose.

Unbalanced Lifelong Learning

Assuming Superiority

Consuls are adept at creating a life that they're satisfied with, but often

at the cost of doing what they're only comfortable with. When deciding not to take a path, Consuls may try to convince themselves that they're just not cut out for it and that everyone who has followed that path is more foolish than Consuls themselves. Consuls can become convinced that they've done everything correctly, will continue to do things correctly, and if they're doing things the right way, then others must be doing things wrong.

Consuls cling to stability because the chance of failing is distinctly lower if the path ahead is already clear. This way of thinking makes perfect sense. However, the issue arises when Consuls are unwilling to step off the path, if even for a moment. This strict adherence allows Consuls to remain in the same place that, while comfortable, may be keeping them from more suitable opportunities.

This line of thinking may also lead Consuls to believe that there is nothing else for them to learn. And even if there are new things to learn, it could hardly be worth the effort to go outside of their comfort zones.

No Time for Learning

Consuls are more than happy to lend a helping hand to those who ask. This inclination to be of service to their loved ones and their community is one of Consuls' best traits, but it can also be their weakness. They can easily lose themselves to day-to-day tasks, and miss out on the opportunity to do other things.

When they allow every moment of their day to be dictated by obligations and expectations – being the model employee, making sure their partner is satisfied, making sure their parents are happy, that the bills are paid, that the house is clean, and a thousand other little things – they could be miss out on vital personal development time. It is possible that years can pass by with Consuls not learning about anything they're personally interested in, or worse, that there's nothing else worth being interested in.

Rebalancing Lifelong Learning

Varying the Routine

Being "set in your ways" isn't necessarily a bad thing. However, there's always room for improving upon an existing routine. Consuls can begin this by picking a relatively mundane task and mixing it up – for example, a walk. Rather than taking the same path every day, Consuls can choose a different path every week. A walk on a forest trail, a walk through the city, or a different route through the neighborhood can all provide a refreshing change, and opportunities to find new things to try around the community.

Based on their small excursions, Consuls can then adjust their routines based on what they liked or disliked. Better yet, they may not change their old routine at all if that's what suits them better. The important thing is that they gain the knowledge of the new to contrast it with the old to make a well-rounded decision.

Incorporating Time to Learn

Time may be the biggest obstacle in any Consul's path of learning. There may be other obligations distracting them from learning more about the things they enjoy. However, it is important for Consuls to carve out time for themselves, and to put themselves first every so often. Creating space for self-care can help lower stress and improve Consuls' overall mood.

They can begin by committing at least an hour a day to learn or practice a skill they enjoy. This hour can be at any time of the day and can be incorporated into their everyday routine. Take, for example, Consuls who like to relax and watch television for a couple of hours at night. They can also use that time to practice knitting or sewing (given they take the extra time to learn the technique).

Even if they can't incorporate the skill they want to learn into their everyday routine, Consuls can choose to make time. They can use social time to invite their friends to learn-a-longs, ensuring there is time to talk and learn skills in events like knitting circles to community baseball leagues to book clubs.

Conclusion

The Responsibility of Growth

When Consuls enter a learning environment, they bring with them the tools and traits to succeed – they can easily integrate among teachers and fellow students, their outgoing manner opening endless learning opportunities. When their focus on social structure is balanced with studious attention to new knowledge, Consuls gain the best of what school has to offer, growing intellectually as well as socially. This can be a wonderful time for this type to embrace the practical benefits of education as well as develop their sense of community with others – life skills that carry them onward.

The educational experience is also an excellent opportunity for Consuls to reach past their own boundaries and conceptions – it's a special time when they have access to many different minds, views, and ideas. Caring enough to genuinely explore diverse paths early in life instead of settling for the rote is a highly responsible way to build a satisfying and balanced set of values. And, practicing the skill of learning itself keeps Consuls from stagnating – they can continue learning after school is over, making life into a classroom. Being wise enough to recognize their own limits and brave enough to step beyond them is a worthy task, and school gives Consuls an exciting way to meet this goal.

Professional Development

Consuls combine their work ethic and attention to detail and protocols with the instinct, encouraged by their Extraverted and Feeling personality traits, to include others in their sensibilities. They are more likely to be found with other people at work than alone. The human element permeates their work lives.

Consequently, Consuls dabble in human resources even if they aren't attached to a formal human resources department. No matter what their level or job title, they find satisfaction in organizing and uniting people around established standards and practices at work – it's a consistent theme repeated throughout this chapter. Their success often depends on the degree to which they balance that agenda with the diverse opinions and preferences of others.

Other People Are the Key

Consuls are gregarious individuals who value their bonds with others. They are the ultimate Extraverts. This type relishes social situations, even if the amiable gathering happens to occur in the middle of an office on a workday. They are fun-loving and capable of turning less than exciting tasks at work into an event. Consuls don't venture very far off the beaten path, but they manage to spice up everyday routines with a sense of camaraderie nonetheless.

As the ultimate team players, Consuls prefer jobs that include a lot of contact with others. They might remain focused when doing isolated jobs, but chances are the work won't satisfy them. Consuls like to feel appreciated, and they need to know their contributions are important.

They often measure this based on how others react to them. When working alone, such feedback may be rare, making things difficult for Consuls. Seeking attention is seen as a weakness in some other types, but not so for Consuls. Getting positive reinforcement motivates Consuls to apply themselves even more. Feedback is essential for this type and is less about ego than developing a sense of purpose and knowing what they're doing counts.

Feelings and Focus

The Feeling trait and its consequent focus on harmony is a defining characteristic for Consuls. Where Sentinels with the Thinking trait may focus almost exclusively on a goal, sometimes at the expense of other people's feelings and concerns, Consuls find it difficult to separate the two.

Not being able to separate the objective from the more subjective approach easily can work two ways. As a benefit, Consuls' goal-orientation can help them when they head a team or are simply just a part of it. They instill a no-nonsense, objective approach with passion rather than a coldness that more rational types may adopt. They can use this to encourage their coworkers to hit whatever their target might be.

On the other hand, they may take it too personally when others don't go along with the standards they hold as important. Such strong feelings may split a unified group into a cliquish "us versus them" configuration. They are, indeed, likely to take things too personally at times. They base their opinions about a colleague's behavior less on whether it's effective and more on whether it aligns with their beliefs and preferences. In a worst-case scenario, such assessments can create a cliquish division composed of two groups: "these people support me, and those people don't." However, in the name of protecting harmony, a lot of criticism may go on behind the backs of those involved.

The Observant and Judging traits reflect Consuls' protective sense of the rules, protocols, and standards. It fosters a "this-or-that" narrative that suggests a single right way and many wrong ways to do a thing. By holding this belief, they sometimes create a complex tension when they try to keep everybody happy and everybody in line at the same time. Consequently, they may attempt to dictate how colleagues should feel or respond to a situation without making an honest effort to discover what is going on with them.

Jobs and General Skill Sets

There is no definitive list of jobs that fit any type exactly, and exceptions always exist. However, this short list of industries shows where Consuls might typically feel at home and provides a good place to start thinking about potential areas of professional interest.

By way of review, Consuls are hardworking and organized, and they enjoy working as part of a team. They don't mind repetitive work or work that focuses on minute details. With this focus on the necessary over the frivolous, many of them find themselves in leadership positions. Consuls are consummate networkers and fill their contacts file with the names of people who are able to contribute to their success. They persist in whatever they start and can be relied on to follow through on major projects.

The following professions reflect some of Consuls' strongest skill sets:

- Customer acquisition
- Management (any context)
- Sales
- Coaching
- Teaching
- Small business ownership

Alternative Options

Both self-employment and entrepreneurship are viable options in the 21st century. No longer are people expected to stay in a single job for 20 years, nor can they expect to. In today's job market, there may be

even more job security and satisfaction in being flexible and taking charge of one's own employment. Consuls are certainly quite capable of thriving in jobs of their making.

Consuls may succeed best at being self-employed while working within an established framework – perhaps buying into a larger franchise. They thrive on respected precedent and are not so prone to pathfinding. But no doubt, once they've landed on the right enterprise, they have the basic organizational skills, the work ethic, and the enthusiasm required to make a solid living.

If taking control of their employment is a feature, a fundamental aspect of self-employment is being the boss. Consuls often discover that their conflicts and problems at work involve the opinions and behaviors of others. Becoming self-employed may eliminate some of these difficulties. After all, it's the boss who makes the decisions, sets the direction, and gets the final word.

On the other hand, if self-employment means working alone, Consuls may find this route difficult. That doesn't mean that Consuls are forced to form companies to enjoy being others or can't freelance independently to be happy. They simply need to find some way to interact with others regularly. Customers or clients are often a great source of interaction, and in the context of business, Consuls' affinity for social outreach makes these interactions even more valuable.

Workplace Roles

Once they've made the decision on the nature of their employment, Consuls can begin to look at their behaviors in the workplace.

The following sections explore Consuls' attributes on the job, including a look at both typical skill sets and how they handle roles within an organization. The "balanced" section describes Consuls at their best, using their strengths wisely. "Unbalanced" describes when overheated strengths or weaknesses prevent them from having an optimal work experience. It often results in a strength turning into too much of a good thing. The "rebalancing" section provides some suggestions, many of them actionable, some of them simply attitudinal, for restoring balance when things are unbalanced.

Consuls as Employees

Balanced Employee Behavior

Starting at the Beginning

It's a natural leap to think of Consuls in leadership positions. Eventually, many end up there. But few take over the boss's office on day one. Employees need to pay their dues, gain experience, and earn respect like anyone, or they may find themselves in over their heads.

Waiting their turn works fine for Consuls, who view life as a series of predictable steps. They have an innate sense of Aristotle's quote, "He who cannot be a good follower cannot be a good leader." They wait their turn while being loyal to their current leaders and refining the skills needed to take the reins someday themselves. With their enthusiasm, Consuls are never simply marking time, no matter what rung of the ladder they're on. There's always the productive and the practical happening.

Work and Validation

Even in subordinate positions, Consuls like to see themselves as having important input. They work to impress bosses and those with whom they work. Even from the beginning, they are likely to apply themselves fully to their jobs. However, as subordinates, Consuls need clear instructions, and intentional goals, especially in the beginning. Hard boundaries and guidelines give Consuls the confidence to move forward.

Balanced Consuls see everyone they work with as members of their social circles. For some types, "mixing business with pleasure" can be complex and difficult. While Consuls may occasionally run into problems in this area, they are largely expert at working with "friends" while remaining focused on professional tasks.

Unbalanced Employee Behavior

The Myth of Loyalty

Most would agree that loyalty is good. For the most part, it is. But Consuls may take it a bit too far in their enthusiasm. Unbridled loyalty can become as troublesome as no loyalty at all. It's the difference

between a sycophant and an employee who is appropriately loyal, yet not afraid to be honest or even critical.

There is a tendency among Consuls to avoid making waves. If they feel excessive loyalty toward their boss, they certainly don't want to upset them. Consequently, they may fail to tell their employers something that may disappoint them or that shows disagreement, even when a directive is misguided. While some managers may prefer this, those with integrity want honest feedback from their workers. Advancement often depends on the quality of one's feedback at some point and not learning to give it honestly out of "loyalty" may well stunt professional growth.

The Illusion of Peace

While they strive to maintain harmony and a friendly atmosphere, Consuls cling to what they believe is right. In the name of keeping the peace, they might not deal with a problem directly, instead, finding an indirect means of expressing their disapproval. That might be through gossiping behind the offender's back or finding other passive-aggressive ways of responding. This roundabout response may give Consuls, with their righteousness satisfied, the false sense that they have addressed the problem when they've simply avoided it.

Consuls may believe they are keeping the peace by not confronting things directly, when, in reality, their indirect methods simply poison the well. Gossip has probably never led to a solution. Even those who listen to the gossip may wonder about the basic integrity of the gossiper. Trust and any prior sense of collegiality may erode, while genuine problems remain hidden, unresolved, and are compounded by negativity. They may wonder what Consuls say about them when they are not in the room.

Rebalancing Employee Behavior

Putting Loyalty in Perspective

Mere decades ago, it was common for people to stay in the same job for their entire lives. Loyalty was largely measured by endurance and longevity. In many cases it involved employees putting the interest of

the company above their personal interests. That thinking has changed drastically. Now, loyalty is more about the quality of contribution, and the amount of serious work provided rather than marking time. Part of "serious work" may include offering thoughtful and honest feedback. This new measure of loyalty changes simply achieving seniority into a more measurably productive tenure, even if it doesn't last forever.

Consuls want to contribute. They need to feel that what they offer in the workplace is important. Using this, they can reframe loyalty to mean that they give honest and therefore important feedback. Of course, every subordinate needs to be respectful and polite when offering such feedback. Not all honesty must be "brutal" honesty. A measure of diplomacy never hurts. But in the end, the truth is more helpful than a sycophantic false loyalty that, in effect, deceives the superior.

The Assertive Subordinate

When Consuls enter the workplace as subordinates, they want to see it as a friendly place where everyone gets along. But few workplaces are free from disagreements and tensions. Because of their harmony-seeking attributes, Consuls may avoid addressing unpleasant situations directly. Learning techniques designed to reduce harsh confrontation while dealing with problems squarely can help Consuls communicate more clearly and effectively while catering to their need for harmony.

While there are dozens of assertiveness techniques, the one that may resonate most with Consuls and can be used immediately is the use of "I feel" statements. For example, instead of saying, "Your work is sloppy. You always leave the counter a mess after your shift," say, "I feel annoyed when I come in and see the counter a mess. We have to spend a good fifteen minutes organizing the work area." "I feel" statements simply place the responsibility for an opinion or an observation on the speaker. It removes any harsh criticism or accusatory tones, instead highlighting how Consuls feel. Using assertiveness techniques, Consuls can approach a situation directly, deal with it honestly, have their needs met, and minimize bad feelings.

Consuls as Colleagues

Balanced Colleague Behavior

The Collegial Coworkers

Inclusiveness is a defining characteristic of Consuls on the job. They want to be included, and they want to include others. They approach working with others eagerly and find pleasure in social interactions at work. When they need to reach out to people as resources, their social ease reveals them to be excellent networkers. Unity is important to them, even if they sometimes express it imperfectly as they struggle to grasp somebody else's perspective.

When things are balanced, Consuls are kind and giving, and they practice a high level of congeniality with their colleagues. In fact, this friendliness is such a prominent part of their work identity that they may even find it hard when they're forced to work alone.

Consuls are genuinely interested in seeing their teams, and the individuals on their teams improve and succeed. The phrase "All for one and one for all" works for Consuls and Musketeers alike. Needless to say, they're tireless members of any work group and are unmatched in their enthusiasm.

Trustworthy

It doesn't take long for Consuls' coworkers to see how reliable they are. Their work ethic is strong, and they remain true to the standards and protocols that define a job. Part of being reliable is being predictably effective. That is an apt description of the typical Consul.

Consuls strive to keep projects on an even keel. Effectiveness largely means doing things "by the book." Consuls, like other Sentinels, feel an obligation to protect tradition and established norms. If coworkers need information about the company's policy or preferred methods, they aren't likely to find anyone more informed than this type. If a task needs completing, they can count on Consuls to do a thorough job because the company expects it.

Unbalanced Colleague Behavior

An Insistent Teammate

It's admirable to want to include coworkers in teams and activities, but Consuls can become insistent on inclusiveness, considering social engagement non-negotiable. Since they work best in a crowd, they might mistakenly assume others operate the same way. They may fail to accept that some thrive on laboring in solitude. Introverts hate few things more than the pressure to join a group. Should some coworkers decline to participate, Consuls may inadvertently create a clique dividing those who are "in" from those who are "out." While their goal may be to unite, things may end up the opposite.

Consuls may also have trouble distinguishing between growth and improvement. Set in their ways as they are, they may fail to take the time to understand what contributes to a specific coworker's professional growth. They may dogmatically decide there is a specific way to help their colleagues improve. They've found an effective method that works for them and just can't stand the idea of seeing others suffer by not enjoying its benefits – no matter what the other person thinks. Consuls' counsel may even help coworkers become more productive than they were. However, it may not be how their colleagues best utilize their unique talents. The good intentions of Consuls may not always match the needs of their friends and coworkers.

Reliability Becomes Rigidity

An important aspect of being part of a team is valuing other team members' input. Consuls may present themselves as caring and receptive to other ideas. However, if they disagree with a particular idea, they are likely to make it a personal issue. They sometimes find it hard to believe that those with alternate opinions can be right. The same dogmatism that prevents them from allowing their team members to grow in their own way can also affect other aspects of their work.

Once a rule, law, or protocol is established, Consuls feel obligated to adhere to it regardless of the circumstances or the outcomes. They may confuse following protocols with effectiveness since they so closely connect the rules with "the right thing to do." Some types may be far more flexible and might freely stretch boundaries if they

need to find some effective solutions. Such disregard for the rules can summon Consuls' previously mentioned judgmental tendencies and create unspoken (or as often as not, clearly declared) tension in the workplace.

Rebalancing Colleague Behavior

Helping Others Feel Valued Too

Consuls like to feel valued. That may be part of the reason they push their perspective so vigorously. It may help them to reframe this attitude. The most valuable thing they might bring to the table is helping others feel valued as well by encouraging them to speak up. Taking a more supportive stance toward colleagues can help Consuls balance their sometimes insistent ways. However, it may take some effort on their part to talk to their colleagues and discover what it is they need to feel valued.

The most valuable thing Consuls can do to help their colleagues may be to listen honestly. Instead of giving one-size-fits-all tips for improvement or a reminder of the rules, they may want to take an extra moment and allow their coworkers to speak without interruption. Consuls may want to examine their listening-to-talking ratio. As a challenge and as a learning experience, Consuls may want to adopt a "question only" position for a while. If the talking seems to outweigh the listening, it may be time to consider whether they know their coworkers well enough to be advising them at all. It may be possible to help them improve without listening, but it's hard to help them grow in its absence.

No More "Rules Police"

Once Consuls have listened to their colleagues, there is yet another step: Accepting their colleagues as individuals responsible for themselves, as individuals capable of deciding for themselves their best direction and interest. Consuls who learn that it is not their role to police the activities or the attitudes of their coworkers find that they enjoy working more and have more productive relationships with colleagues. Inclusion and working together doesn't mean trying to control others.

Consuls identify with standards so closely they may begin to take it personally when others thumb their noses at such conventions. If it is in Consuls' job description to monitor and oversee such things, then, naturally, they must attend to them. If a coworker's behavior impedes Consuls' work, then, of course, they have to deal with it. However, if neither thing is true, they may want to ask themselves what they get out of judging their coworkers and, speaking plainly, if it's any of their business. Consuls are happier and more effective if they cut these extraneous concerns from their lives and allow themselves a sense of appreciation for the different perspectives others bring to the table.

Consuls as Managers

Balanced Manager Behavior

Natural Organizers

Whether upper management, middle management, or leading from among peers, Consuls possess an impulse to organize and often set the direction for a team or group. Well-balanced Consuls efficiently sort tasks needed to complete a job or project, delegate wisely, and know how to appreciate the long view needed for reaching goals. Based on the experience and trustworthiness of their team members, they also invite constructive criticism and advice. Consuls are social individuals who enjoy networking and creating partnerships with others. These characteristics become vital tools when they accept management positions.

Consul managers enjoy uniting people and managing them. They do their best to create a warm and conflict-free workplace, as they understand it. They respect traditional hierarchies and encourage their subordinates to do the same. (This, of course, in moderation as blind followers can be taken advantage of and may be less useful than honest brokers.) Consuls enjoy the power that comes from responsibility, but they see as benefits beyond their ambitions. There is a conviction that they serve a greater good.

Social Leadership

Consuls are those leaders who bring a sense of family and fun to the job. That doesn't mean they aren't serious about accomplishing their

goals. But if they can infuse the work day with something slightly more stimulating, especially in the social realm, they do. They're likely to be the managers who, for example, create contests around meeting quotas or hold celebration parties when reviewing positive feedback from customers. In fact, Consuls are likely to hold a lot of celebrations (if company policy permits them), believing that the emotional focus on success leads to better morale and stronger productivity.

Consuls are likely to feel attached to their subordinates. When balanced, they remind them of the rules and the structures and use the company's accepted best practices as guidelines for helping them improve while accepting that there is usually room for individual styles within these guidelines that allow each person to grow in the way that works for them. They work to keep harmony and high morale, but they do so within the context of promoting the company, becoming corporate cheerleaders at times. Yet they do not allow their friendliness to take the focus away from their serious loyalty to the business – it's instead a way of proving that loyalty.

Unbalanced Manager Behavior

Too Much Focus on the Plan

Organization is a tool that holds immense value in business. However, Consuls can become rigidly entranced by desired goals and may place them even above the desired outcomes and any flexibility needed to reach them. In doing so, they can lose vital flexibility. The best plans can go awry. Sometimes, plans need revising, and Consuls too sold on theirs as "the only way" may not maneuver as quickly as they need to.

Consuls, all of whom rely on the Judging trait, desire things to be predictable. The need to ensure predictability breeds a need to exert control, which can be a strength unless it hardens into rigidity. Life regularly throws curveballs often making plans useless. Consul managers who are not flexible enough to handle them may come up short.

Taking Things Personally

Consuls may not be as skilled at compartmentalizing the different aspects of their work lives as other leaders might be. In the end, what

matters in business is not how happy and conflict-free the staff is, but rather how effectively they've done their jobs. Consuls' preferred warm demeanor may clash with the cold reality of directly enforcing effectiveness.

Many managers find delivering tough assessments or taking disciplinary actions difficult. Consuls may think of their staff as friends and even family, but that does not always serve a manager well. It can send mixed messages that muddy the waters. Consuls may have trouble dealing directly with their "friends" who work for them for fear of hurting their feelings. The "friends," in turn, may expect inappropriately gentle handling. Sometimes managers must take actions which leave others unhappy. It's a fact of management life.

Furthermore, in friendly relations with subordinates, there may be the danger of employees taking advantage of Consul managers. Boundaries and compartmentalization serve the purpose of keeping people honest in their roles. Employees who forget that their "friend" is also their boss, may innocently expect to receive favors from their Consul managers. Less innocently, some may choose to appear friendly just to get on the right side of the boss and perhaps be allowed privileges others may not receive.

Rebalancing Manager Behavior

Building in Flexibility

Reality dictates that planning is beneficial, but knowing when to modify it is also valuable. Anticipating problems beforehand and building in contingency plans can help. For Consuls, planning for eventualities can seem like inserting an excuse to deviate from an established strategy. However, a simple reframe is to see contingency plans not as watering down the original plan, but as controlling it.

Sometimes challenges to a plan are a complete surprise, and there is no contingency plan ready. Sometimes a flexible attitude is all one needs to conquer an unanticipated problem. Actively expecting the unexpected, and consciously adopting a willingness to change course when needed can help Consuls to regain control of a wayward plan.

Balancing the resolve to stay on course with a willingness to circumvent unexpected hazards can save the day when a plan approaches a rocky shoal.

Fortifying Boundaries

Consuls may want to explore how solid their boundaries are about their staff. Manager-subordinate relationships are never equal, no matter how friendly they are. One holds power, and one doesn't. Fortunately for Consuls, company policies sometimes dictate how these relationships are handled – some prohibit dating, for example. A set of rules plays right into Consuls' style of operating. In the absence of policy, they might take a hard look at the way they interact with their subordinates and design rules of their own.

A repeated theme for Consuls involves communicating clearly and directly. Managers probably need this skill more than at any other workplace role. Learning to do so allows them to keep relationships straight and in their proper compartments. No hedging and no talking behind others' backs. Having a clear picture of the nature of a relationship and combining that with a reasonable amount of directness and diplomacy can rebalance many difficulties involving role boundaries and communication.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

Cooperation and communication are essential for any business endeavor to run smoothly and to meet its goals. In most business settings, there are likely to be other personality types, and working well with them may be crucial. In the sections below, relationships between the different Role groups and Consuls will be explored. The "balanced" section looks at when the relationships work well and are mutually beneficial. The "unbalanced" section discusses potential problems and conflicts, and the "rebalancing" section offers methods or ideas for repairing unbalanced relationships.

Consul-Analyst Cooperation

While some Analysts share the Extraverted and Judging traits with Consuls, there are no traits intrinsically the same as Consuls' across all Analyst types. However, that doesn't mean that there is no common ground that can be shared by all. Both Consuls and Analysts are passionate about systems. While Analysts have a penchant for creating and refining them, Consuls are more likely to look for ways to comply with them and preserve them.

Balanced Consul-Analyst Cooperation

Domesticating Change

Stepping back and looking at these two types from a wider perspective, Analysts are likely to create the mold into which Consuls will eventually fit. Analysts like to shake up systems and frameworks to make them better. However, much can be said for stability, and Consuls play a role in taming change that is too haphazard or scattered. They slow things down enough to allow the people involved with the system time to adjust to change. One offers a broader way of thinking. The other domesticates it to fit the real, practical world.

Even though there is room for overlap, Consuls and Analysts serve two distinct roles if their approaches are allowed to flourish. As a team, they can back each other up. Consuls will demonstrate how Analysts' visions are achievable and will be instrumental in making that happen. Analysts can support Consuls' interpretation of their plans as consistent. Putting three people at the counter in the morning will be necessary if the fresher, more profitable muffins are coming out of the oven at 6:00 a.m. instead of being prepared the night before. Vision and execution feed off of each other when this pairing is balanced.

Moderating Influences

As moderating influences, the two can contribute to each other's work in significant ways. Cooperation between them is the product of accepting that they both offer something of value that leads to the same end – effective outcomes. Where Analysts offer broader solutions and visions, Consuls are masters at organizing their implementation and bringing them to reality. A sincere collaboration between the two is a crossroads where ideas become achievements and old ways transform into more effective new ways.

For example, Analysts may bring a larger blueprint for serious change that is very task- and result-oriented. The steps and the contingencies may all be in place. However, they may fail to consider things like personnel and the reasonable timelines needed to allow the workforce to accomplish the steps. At that point, Consuls can step in and provide insight into the day-to-day, human concerns that they need to address before a company can implement the plans. Complementing each other's focus can help develop a full plan that not only promotes an effective direction but also takes necessary daily matters into account.

Unbalanced Consul-Analyst Cooperation

Experimentation and Caution

Tensions are likely to mount if Analysts change things too casually. Consuls prefer proven solutions and need time to test new ideas before they accept them, and they see anything too inventive as introducing chaos into their trusted strategies. Analysts are less likely to focus on the risks associated with experimentation. Sometimes they may even indulge in experimenting simply for the sake of trying something out. Such experimentation provides no measurable contribution to the goals, and, consequently, Consuls are likely to reject them soundly.

Consuls may label Analysts as loose cannons with wild ideas. In turn, Analysts may begin to think of Consuls as uptight enemies of innovation. When both or either frames their relationships as adversarial rather than collaborative, they stop being useful to each other, and the larger enterprise becomes weaker due to a lack of cooperation.

If one is subordinate to the other in Consuls-Analyst work relationships, either of them maintaining a stubborn allegiance to a particular focus can be problematic. Automatically taking a position without giving a full hearing to any alternate views can be counterproductive. Very real and negative results can happen when there is a power difference. These might include a lack of promotion, a lack of basic respect, low morale, and even job loss.

Differing Styles

Working together, Consuls and Analysts may at times face clashes that are more about personality than substance. Consuls are sensitive and when that is paired with their deep conviction about how things "should be," they may be easily upset in the workplace. Analysts, on the other hand, are not always attuned to emotions and sometimes are perplexed when their rational solutions are met with a highly sensitive reaction. When these two attitudes meet, there might a tangible sense of incompatibility.

When unbalanced, Consuls and Analysts might hold each other in poor regard. Consuls may think Analysts cold and calculating. Analysts may consider Consuls too obsessed with the feelings of others and with an agenda built mostly on old ideas. Consuls might interpret that as Analysts being disrespectful of the things that are important to them. It can stop being a war of ideas and approaches and become a matter of hurt feelings and a perceived assault on Consuls' egos.

Rebalancing Consul-Analyst Cooperation

Breaking a Stalemate

If Consul and Analyst coworkers find themselves in conflict too often, they may need to define for themselves what the other person offers. In the heat of battle, it's easy to downplay the value of a coworker who is not in agreement. Reminding themselves of the other's value may restore balance. But more than a "touchy feely" approach, these types need to quantify real results, or potential results, for each to take this assessment seriously. Doing so not only helps to break the stalemate but might also help the coworkers revisit some of the ways that those they work with might be better utilized. Here is one way to approach it:

To explore a chronically contentious relationship at work, take an inventory of the other person's success or their measurable movement toward success. The inventory should be real profiles in productivity and not simply a list of qualifications. Reciting qualifications, labels or degrees, may impress, but they don't necessarily speak to effectiveness and results.

Once the inventory is complete, review how much of the material on the list is still relevant to future work and goals:

- What have the Consuls or Analysts done well, or what are they doing well, and how can that be applied to the job at hand?
- Where do the coworkers' work interests overlap?
- How can each coworker strategically tap into the other's skills or strengths to be even more effective as a team?

Taking Oneself More Lightly

Misunderstanding of other personality types is not always about the other person. Often, it is because one or both parties take their style too seriously. For Consuls, it's that everyone should be happy and harmonious while adapting to the standards they have accepted. Those who don't comply may find themselves subtly shunned by Consuls, or even directly challenged if they've really pushed too far. For Analysts, taking themselves too seriously takes the form of exaggerating the importance of their rationality and foisting their opinions too aggressively onto others. They may at times fail to hear others' opinions, assuming theirs to be superior.

Therefore, rebalancing means finding some way to appreciate style diversity in the workplace and admitting that dissimilar styles still offer value. For Consuls, rebalancing involves looking at the essentials Analysts bring – things like being data-driven, rational, and their focus on accuracy and efficiency. For Analysts, rebalancing involves understanding that the company is a system that relies on human capital and that humans like the appreciation and stability provided by Consuls.

Consul-Diplomat Cooperation

Consuls and Diplomats are kindred spirits. As a team, they are mostly interested in the human factors that permeate most workplaces. Consuls view others from a down-to-earth perspective, and Diplomats empathize to a degree bordering on the spiritual. They share the Feeling trait, which makes them both passionate about their beliefs and standards as they apply not only to themselves but also to other people.

Balanced Consul-Diplomat Cooperation

Consensus and Cooperation

Both Consuls and Diplomats respect consensus and cooperation. Both are happiest when people are in agreement, and everyone is getting along. It's unsettling for either of them to face conflict or to have to deal with any form of hostility or disagreement (although fighting for the right principle can bring the warrior out in both). Together, Consuls and Diplomats may bring a sense of unity to the workplace and smooth over some of the rough edges that naturally come about when people with varied working styles are employed in the same place.

Consuls and Diplomats both like the idea of people becoming "better." As mentioned above, Consuls look for improvement according to the standards they set or adhere to. Diplomats are more likely to encourage people to grow in their way, although they do oppose anything that feels like others have wandered into morally questionable areas. While their focuses are different, it's still conceivable that balanced Consuls and Diplomats can find common ground in personnel training and development. Together, they might build a program that not only provides precise skills or understanding but also takes into account the differing interests and abilities of those who participate.

Alike but Different

It would be an oversimplification to say that Consuls are doers while Diplomats are strictly dreamers. Certainly, Consuls dream in their fashion and Diplomats act in theirs. But despite the reality of some overlap, Consuls are the more practical of the two types.

It's a subjective judgment call to say pragmatism is a more vital tool at work than being a visionary – and a lot depends on job descriptions. In the case of Consuls working with Diplomats and sharing the touchstone of the Feeling trait with them, there's plenty of room for complementary cooperation despite their unique styles of doing things. For example, while Diplomats may explore new ideas about workplace cohesion and present theories around that, Sentinels can add their pragmatic magic to the ideas and find applications that work in a specific business. Diplomats can provide a vision that resonates with Consuls, and Consuls then translate it to real life. Their end goals are likely the same: a place where people effectively work together and experience some form of satisfaction while doing so.

Unbalanced Consul-Diplomat Cooperation

Oppressive Caring

In their zeal to make life better for their fellow employees and to improve their lives, Consuls and Diplomats will often decide that they know what is best for others. If they work closely together, they are likely to reinforce that belief in each other. In short, they may push their ideas and preferred actions as something others should do for "their own good." In fact, both types have been known to insist on it, and therein, lies the problem.

Consuls and some Diplomat coworkers both have a focus on others and a Judging trait that organizes their views. In the extreme, they can combine the two and become a little tyrannical about their own ways. While their goal is unity and cohesiveness, such strict expectations of others can create the opposite atmosphere – denying the individual characteristics, preferences, and styles of coworkers can be divisive.

Hard Matters and Soft Matters

With both so focused on human capital, attitudes, and behaviors and less on objective measures, Consuls and Diplomats potentially set up an echo chamber that may distract from a business. Where others may be insisting on more data-driven proof of effectiveness, Consuls and Diplomats working together may create more drama-driven outcomes.

In business, there is often talk of soft skills, the kind Consuls and Diplomats excel in, and hard skills, those that bring more direct results. Both types are important, but if allowed to shift out of balance, they can contribute to a workplace being difficult. Without the soft "human" skills that Consuls and Diplomats working together might deliver, there can be low morale leading indirectly to loss of productivity. However, too much focus on that and it saps energy from the results that make businesses viable. If Consul and Diplomat coworkers manage to create an echo chamber that is dense in emotional decision-making, their contribution dilute more task-oriented endeavors.

Rebalancing Consul-Diplomat Cooperation

Finding Common Ground

There is no doubt that rules and standards are necessary on the job, and Consuls stand as guardians of such things, providing stability and consistency. But when too much of a legalistic approach turns humans into cogs in a machine designed to do someone else's bidding, blending in some of the intuitive connections that Diplomats excel in forming can help "rehumanize" the process. This is the balance: maintaining structure while respecting individuality. Both are vital in the workplace. Rejecting Consuls' focus invites chaos. Rejecting Diplomats' focus invites low morale.

At some point, when rebalancing work relationships between different types, the word "tolerance" always comes up. There is an economy among the differing personalities. All types are needed, and none is wasted. The person who navigates relationships between types best is the person who goes beyond tolerating to embracing the valuable gifts other types bring. For Consuls, it may mean accepting that Diplomats bring a different dimension of feeling that has a greater respect for the

individual. For their part, Diplomats can learn to be more realistic and practical in their treatment of others.

To achieve this better, Consuls and Diplomats may need to establish an understanding of the motivations and foundational beliefs of the other. Fortunately, both are interested in exploring such things, even if they may, at times, be a little reluctant to accept what they hear. They are often caught up in their assumptions. One way to build a better understanding of each is to find a way to test the things that they assume about their coworkers. Simple assumption testing can clear up a lot of conflict between Consuls and Diplomats. Once Consuls have resolved their conflicts, they are likely to be well-practiced at doing so and will find it easier to address conflicts with people who do not fit their Feeling and Judging trait ideals. The following can set a precedent for how to deal with others:

- Take a situation where there is disagreement. It may be safer to start with milder situations until trust is built.
- Now, write three assumptions about how the other person views the situation.
- Test the assumptions. Ask the other person if the held assumption about them is true. It's important to remember to listen free of judgment. This isn't about correcting the other person, but understanding them better. If possible, a neutral observer to cry "foul" when judgments are delivered, may help. But at the minimum, self-monitoring is required.
- Finally, when everyone's assumptions are clear, look for common ground. Where do the approaches overlap? Where can they be used together to improve things?

Letting Go

Just because both Diplomats and Consuls rely on the Feeling trait for their decisions doesn't mean that either lacks rationality. In fact, there's rationality in emotional decision-making. At times, it makes sense to decide from one's emotional intelligence. But a more basic rationality may be exactly the thing to turn to when more emotional agendas are at odds.

One of the best ways to break a stalemate is to introduce a new element to the mix. That may sound obvious, but it's easy to forget when standing one's ground in a contentious situation. For Consuls and Diplomats, introducing that "new element" may mean simply sitting down and trying a colder, more rational approach. Perhaps it is helpful, in such situations, to invite the input of someone who has a more analytical mind. Balancing all the elements of good decision-making is likely to be more effective than just relying on a preferred style.

Consul-Sentinel Cooperation

Consuls are just one of the personality types in the Sentinel Role group. Each type in this group shares the Observant and Judging traits with the other three types. The chief things they have in common are a rigorous work ethic, a reverence for tradition or rules according to the culture they're a part of, and a solid respect for all things practical.

Working with other Sentinels appeals to Consuls' pragmatism. With their Sentinel peers, they can avoid some of the issues they face with their less practical colleagues. While some Sentinels may not share Consuls' Extraverted sociability or their gregariousness enhanced by the Feeling trait, they all share a focus on being reliable and loyal.

Balanced Consul-Sentinel Cooperation

A Shared Sense of Mission

Consuls and other Sentinels honor efficiency, details, and protocols. As Consuls ascend, as they typically do, to their roles as leaders, they may rely heavily on other Sentinels to help them meet their goals. They may feel confident that their Sentinel cousins understand their objectives,

and that like-mindedness fosters connections. When balanced, other Sentinels can help them stay on track and help them focus on the practical ends rather than interpersonal dramas that may occur along the way.

Consuls and their Sentinel cousins have an appreciation for a clear direction uncluttered by information that they feel is impractical. That would include anything theoretical, or anything that too harshly challenges the established system. Interactions between them are likely to focus on the next best step to take. They're not prone to bog themselves down with a lot of discussions involving "why" questions, being more inclined to "how" questions. That shouldn't imply a lack of concern about the reason behind strategies, but once they embark on a plan, Consuls and Sentinels aren't likely to revisit or revise rationales often.

Shared Sensibilities

Not all Sentinels share Consuls' preference for friendliness and harmony, especially the Introverted among them. The combination of Extraversion and the Feeling trait sets Consuls apart from all other Sentinels and makes them the most social among them. However, all Sentinels have a strong interest in the welfare of the people in their lives, even if they don't express it as openly as Consuls. This aura of service to others bonds Consuls to other Sentinels in tacit ways and inspires diligence in both.

Consuls and Sentinels, sitting together in the lunchroom, discuss down-to-earth matters. The conversation flows easily due to shared basic values. Among other things, the diners may discuss their work and the progress of their projects. Work is serious business to both. They may discuss the strengths and weaknesses of their coworkers – maybe basing their judgments on a coworker's effectiveness, but just as likely measuring them against some more formal set of standards.

Unbalanced Consul-Sentinel Cooperation

Time with like-minded coworkers can be a pleasure. However, it can also help create an insular environment. Pairing with a similar type can

sometimes result in a tedious abundance of sameness. For Consul-Sentinel collaborations, the tedium plays out mainly through their established expectations and a lack of flexibility.

A Chorus of Agreement

While embracing established methods promotes stability, being unreceptive to new ideas bodes poorly in the modern business world. Few businesses have remained as they were 20 years ago. They will be unrecognizable 20 years from now. Too many Sentinels in a room can potentially slow innovation and, consequently, productivity, to a snail-like pace, harming competitiveness.

Consuls and Sentinels demonstrating unbalanced cooperation support each other in rejecting needed innovations, forming a wall of opposition. They show an intolerance for those who introduce an unorthodox method too quickly. Too much combined Sentinel reverence for tradition turns new ideas and methods into a threat to their established means of operating, at least initially.

Should Consuls ascend to leadership, depending on those too similar to themselves may create a cluster of "yes" people as advisors, who are less likely to offer constructive criticism or useful pushback. Consuls with an unbalanced approach may welcome the otherwise dreaded echo chamber.

Playing It Safe

Another problem that may arise from an unbalanced Consul-Sentinel echo chamber is a raised aversion to risk. These types working together may simply play it too safe. Added responsibility tempers risky behavior. With Consuls' and Sentinels' reverence for tradition and their feeling of responsibility for the people in their lives, they may avoid even the most necessary risks out of fear of hurting either.

They would prefer the tried and true over the risky experimental. But then, hesitating too long can be deadly in a time of change. To say it casually, "If you snooze, you lose." Risk-averse Consuls and Sentinels keep things steady, but perhaps, at times, too steady. Sentinels are the least impulsive group, and it may be prudent to add the voices of some who are willing to take chances to the conversation. History is

full of examples of people who lost out because they were too cautious and hesitant. Sentinels and Consuls, in particular, can be judgmental when they see others fail. This can make them less willing to risk the judgment of others by taking a chance that might lead to failure.

Rebalancing Consul-Sentinel Cooperation

Invite Diverse Input

Support from Sentinels can empower Consuls. But so can recognizing that such relationships have limits and acknowledging that helpful alternatives may exist just a step outside of this pairing's comfort zone. Rebalancing may be as simple as considering that a current set of options may be too narrow and making a deliberate decision to add diverse voices to the conversation which may come from inviting

It's difficult to invite dissenting voices to the table. People enjoy others agreeing with them. However, if dissent is needed, an invitation isn't usually required. They are probably already there. They may be silent and stay in the background due to a too-rigid work culture. Sometimes, they are simply ignored. Creating a more accepting environment or developing an individual attitude of openness can bring needed devil's advocates out of the shadows. When Consul-Sentinel dominated groups put the search for workable solutions above the comfort of being agreed with, valuable alternative voices begin to feel welcomed.

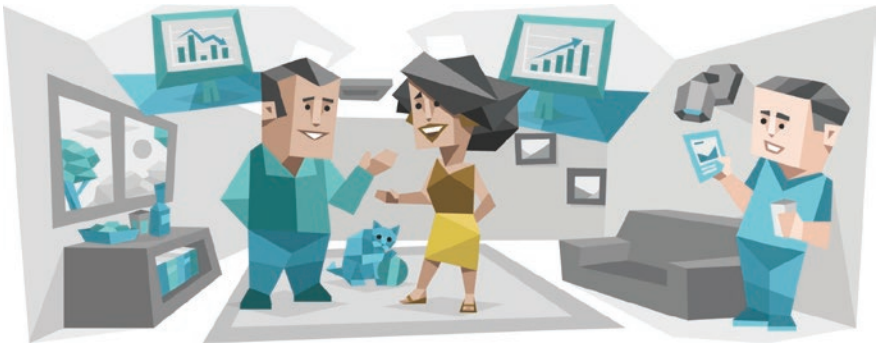
Failing Fast

Business author Tom Peters advises, "Test fast. Fail fast. Adjust fast." He is describing the current swift momentum that sweeps most businesses along. Such advice can send a shiver down the spine of the typical predictability-loving Sentinel. Adopting the mindset that life is a series of calculated risks can help Sentinels cling to safety a little less. As the familiar old saying goes, "Ships are safe in harbor, but that's not what ships are for."

Consuls and their Sentinel coworkers might work together to create a culture that is tolerant of reasonable failure and experimentation. Inviting other personality types to offer their opinions and giving them enough breathing space to try new things can help Sentinels discover

the value of taking risks and trying innovative ideas. Perhaps, instituting panels that include a diverse level of experience, where available, can help nourish a more inventive climate. The more experienced can blend the benefit of their wisdom and histories with novel ideas of the less experienced who are not as influenced by tradition. Their mission would be to create a synergy of their perspectives. Such panels would both protect the tradition and standards Sentinels love while promoting new ways of thinking.

Consul-Explorer Cooperation



Consuls share the Observant trait with all Explorers and the Extraverted and Feeling traits with some of them. What they don't share with any Explorers is their Judging trait, and this one trait can powerfully influence the others. Prospecting Explorers have a much more casual relationship with standards and rules than Consuls do. Where Consuls enjoy predictability and order, their Explorer colleagues like novelty. This difference colors all their interactions both positively and negatively.

Balanced Consul-Explorer Cooperation

Complementary Work Relationship

It's easy to get the impression that Consuls and Explorers are complete opposites. Consuls are likely to view Explorers as impulsive and irresponsible. Explorers likely see Consuls as friendly, but rigid and unadventurous. Those might be unbridgeable gaps between the two types if they didn't share a deep respect for a mutual attention to concrete matters.

Consuls and Explorers most often complement each other when things go wrong. Consuls have a repertoire of reliable solutions, but those occasionally fail in novel situations. When this happens, Explorer coworkers are irreplaceable. They think on their feet and are masters at solving unexpected issues. If Consuls and Explorers can learn to appreciate their differences, they can develop an effective tag-team approach to cover the routine and the unexpected.

Balanced Attitude

Consuls and Explorers are so dissimilar that they can balance each other almost perfectly. Consuls may have trouble admitting they need free spirits like Explorers on their teams, but even they at times must admit they can be too uptight. Explorers may worry that "playing the game" may rob them of their independence, but they may quietly admit to themselves that a little more structure could make their lives better.

When such coworkers find a way to blend their perspectives, they can be dynamic in covering both those things that require protocols and those that need improvisation. Consul and Explorers who successfully work together adopt a "best of all worlds" attitude and succeed in covering all contingencies.

Unbalanced Consul-Explorer Cooperation

Tight Ship versus Free-Form Solutions

Consuls may appreciate Explorers' clever, spontaneous solutions that save the day on occasion. However, there are limits, and they will likely reach a point where Explorers' disregard for the rules becomes too much. Rules represent stability to all Sentinels. There is nothing more important to Consuls than a harmonious workplace resting on social conventions. Explorers who take too many liberties may begin to represent a serious threat to its overall steadiness.

If Consuls are the boss or manager, they may clamp down excessively on Explorers. An attempt to pull them into the fold and to make sure they march lockstep with others can damage a sound working relationship by ignoring the strengths Explorers would otherwise bring. Tightening the reins beyond a straightforward list of objectives may be ill-advised.

Should Explorers be in charge, Consuls may feel that things are a bit chaotic. They may continuously look to the leader to enforce order and then experience some disappointment when they don't. Consuls may lose respect for their Explorer managers who they may view as being "sloppy" with protocols. They may even feel condescending toward their undisciplined superior. They may even reach a point where they can no longer abide their manager's lack of structure and challenge them directly. This rebellious attitude would uncharacteristic to Consuls who have deep respect hierarchies and usually display loyalty to their superiors.

Losing Autonomy

Independence is a major concern for Explorers. However, there are rules to follow, and Consuls may feel an obligation to reject Explorers and their freewheeling ways. They may forget that their independent thinking is the thinking that inspires their timely, perhaps unorthodox solutions. Explorers not only think outside the box, but they also reject the very notion that the box exists. Meanwhile, Consuls may try everything they can to construct one around them.

Explorers who feel trapped always develop exit strategies. When Consuls challenge Explorers' autonomy without some respect for the purpose it serves in their lives, there exists the possibility of failure on many levels. Rejecting Explorers' independent natures and independent thinking is rejecting the valuable talents they bring to the table. In trying to control the unpredictable Explorer, Consuls may lose a valuable asset. In trying to do so, they demonstrate a deep disrespect for their coworkers and lessen the chance for successful collaboration. This the exact opposite of what they generally aspire to accomplish.

Rebalancing Consul-Explorer Cooperation

A Courageous Exchange

Taking a leap of faith and trusting another person's unproven methods takes a great deal of courage – especially for types who thrive on being "in the know," like Consuls. Courageous Consuls might look for ways to learn from the attitudes of Explorers. Explorers' love of change, new

stimulation, and general independence can help Consuls broaden their perspectives a little if they're willing to go along for the ride. Professional growth comes from expanding one's comfort zone, and Explorers certainly dabble with things beyond those boundaries.

Likewise, Consuls can help willing Explorers become more attuned to accepted social standards. Whether they approve of them or not, there are always established expectations in business. Consuls can help them get a handle on them should they wish to climb the ladder to a higher position or take their job skills to a new level. When playing this game, chalking up another win is usually achieved by playing by the rules – but sometimes those rules need to be bent or broken to get done what needs to be done.

However, none of this comes without effort. First comes awareness, then a commitment to appreciating the value the other offers. There is no mechanical or physical trick or exercise to bring about such appreciation on a comprehensive scale. One might try something like thinking of three good things to say about someone before criticizing them or adding them to their gratitude list in specific and descriptive ways as first aid. But ultimately, it's a matter of decision and attitude. Consuls may want to decide to appreciate the fresh and slightly rebellious attitudes that Explorers bring to their work lives, especially when they produce results.

The Explorer Two-Step

Consuls who work with Explorers may want to think of this experience as a kind of dance. Dancing with a partner usually assumes an element of flexibility, where the partners anticipate each other's moves – yet there is some structure maintained in their movements. The delicate dance of knowing when to assert boundaries and rules and when to let Explorers try unorthodox moves on their own is essential for Consuls who work with them.

When it matters, Consuls may want to enforce protocols. When it's not that important, perhaps they might loosen up a bit. Again, that doesn't mean wholesale disregard for the rules, but exercising a little more flexibility and taking a bit of a risk can pay off at times. In doing so, they are acknowledging the positive attributes of their Explorer colleagues and are a step closer to providing the unity at work that they desire.

Conclusion

The lesson for Consuls may be that those who learn to include diverse personality types and styles in their work lives will find that they add more talent to their collaborations. Learning to appreciate their own professional strengths and weaknesses and those of other types can help them find a way to navigate work and life more effectively. Letting go of some of their preconceptions and expectations can also liberate them to grow in their own professional lives.

Some have said that when people come to the end of their lives, they are unlikely to think about all the hours they spent at work as a highlight of existence. That may be true for most, but it might not apply to Consuls. For them, their work is likely to be a defining part of themselves, one aspect of a life well-lived, highlighted both by professional accomplishments and by the social connections that they built during their career.

Final Words

Consuls play a vital role in their school and work environments, often acting as the glue holding their teams together. They are traditionalists at heart, rarely straying from the rules and expectations set before them. Seeing the fruits of their labor unfold is deeply gratifying, though they aren't ones to chase solitary success – they enjoy seeing their peers succeed beside them too. With a genuine interest in helping others and some structure put in place to guide them, Consuls are a warm, supportive addition to any classroom or workplace.

But as they seek to implement their values, they inevitably find challenges, as no great effort is free of resistance. For example, people with this personality type may struggle to accept coworkers and managers who don't share their ideas and principles. Rather than letting go of their values, Consuls can let go of the expectation that everyone will share those values.

Similarly, education is often an area where people with this personality type can demonstrate how dedicated and studious they are, but they may also benefit from listening to teachers and thought leaders who have different approaches. Consuls may find that a little flexibility makes academic and work frustrations easier to overcome.

Our hope is that these pages have affirmed the gifts that Consuls offer the world through their studies and professional endeavors, while also providing tools to manage the challenges that they may face in school and work. By balancing their work ethic with personal needs, accepting opposing views in school or the workplace, and pursuing professional roles that play to their strengths, Consuls can find long-term fulfillment in their academic and professional careers.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you excel in your career? Explore our Career Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your relationships? Check out the *Consul Guide to Relationships*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Consul Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

All contents copyright ©2011–2023 NERIS Analytics Limited. All rights reserved. This document is intended for personal use only and no part of it may be translated, shared, reproduced or transmitted in any form, by any means (electronic, photocopying, recording, or otherwise) without the prior written permission of the publisher.

The publisher has used its best efforts in preparing this document, and the information provided herein is provided "as is." NERIS Analytics Limited will assume no liability nor responsibility to any person or entity with respect to any loss or damage related directly or indirectly to the information in this document (including any action or inaction taken or not taken as result of the information contained herein). Any decisions that you make once you have read this document are for you alone and we won't be liable for the consequences of any such decisions.

No warranties of any kind, express or implied, are made, and the publisher specifically disclaims any implied warranties of fitness for any particular purpose. The publisher will provide no remedy for indirect, consequential, punitive, incidental, or other damages arising from this document, including such from negligence, strict liability, or breach of warranty or contract, even after notice of the possibility of such damages.

The publisher is not engaged in rendering legal, medical, financial, or other professional services. The information in this document is educational in nature, is provided only as general information, and is not psychological advice. Transmission of this information is not intended to create, and receipt doesn't constitute a psychologist-client relationship. Furthermore, this information is not intended to be used to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease or psychological disorder.

This document is only available for purchase at https://www.16personalities.com. If you have downloaded this document from any other website or if it has been included in any service not provided by NERIS Analytics Limited, please be aware this is very likely an unauthorized copy. In such and similar cases, we would be very grateful if you could get in touch with us via our website at https://www.16personalities.com/contact-us so that we could investigate. Thank you!